

Dat Tran

Born April 30, 1988 in Hanoi, Vietnam, German Citizen

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Summary

Seasoned technology and business leader with extensive experience in creating, transforming and leading both large and small (technological) organizations. Passion for building up high performance, cross-functional and self-managed balanced teams (from scratch). Entrepreneurial mindset through my family's business. Open-source and machine learning evangelist with global reach. Big fan of agile practices, lean product development & extreme programming practices.

Highlights:

- I established and led Axel Springer AI (<https://ai.axelspringer.com/>), the artificial intelligence unit of Axel Springer SE, one of the largest digital publishing house in Europe
- Driving Axel Springer's change into a real "tech" company:
 - Established and managed the Axel Springer Tech Blog
 - Co-organized the Axel Springer TechCon 2019 which was the first installment of a group-wide conference within the Axel Springer group
 - Established a more open-source and research-driven mindset with several successful open-source projects e.g. imagededup 3k stars, image-super-resolution 1.9k stars etc.
- Turned idealo's data team from a pure cost center into a profit center e.g. monetizing our data for CRM campaigns which resulted in EUR 1m additional revenue in the 1st year and EUR 2m in the 2nd year
- Built up a new branch for my family's restaurant business, scaled up to EUR 2m annual revenue and 15 employees until I got bored
- (Keynote) speaker at several internal and external conferences e.g WeAreDevelopers, PyData etc.
- Mentor for AI, (tech) products and leadership
- My (online) publications reach thousands of viewers: 78k+ followers on LinkedIn

Experience

- **Datacidars SE** Berlin, GER
Partner *09/2026 - Present*
 - Datacidars is the No. 1 leading data and AI specialist in Germany. As a hands-on partner, I help companies turn ideas into production-ready AI and data products with measurable business impact.

- **DATANOMIQ GmbH (Acq. by Dataciders)** Berlin, GER
Partner & Co-CEO 02/2025 - Present
 - Advising companies on their AI & data journey—from the initial idea to full implementation. As a trusted partner in AI, BI, and Process Mining, I don't just tell you what you want to hear—I tell you what's right. No Bullshit Bingo mentality. I focus on delivering real value: no unnecessary meetings, no endless PowerPoint slides—just fast, effective product delivery. And yes, I also ship code!
 - Scaled the company, doubled the revenue and increased the margin from 25% to 35% in less than 2 years, then exited to strategic partner Dataciders SE in August 2026 to build a European AI champion
- **Dat Tran Ventures** Berlin, GER
Fractional CTO 01/2015 - Present
 - Advising companies on various product & tech related topics such as:
 - * Technology (AI, data, cloud) & open-source strategy
 - * Culture & transformation (from old economy to digital)
 - * Capability and process building (central vs. decentralized organizations, research teams etc.)
 - * Building successful high performing (tech) teams with a clear strategy & mission
 - * And many more...
 - Giving talks (both technical ones to keynotes), workshops and mentoring
 - Some of my clients: Beiersdorf, Bertelsmann, Axel Springer, Sparkasse, Süddeutscher Verlag etc.
- **Philipps & Byrne** Berlin, GER
Expert for AI/ML, Data & Software topics 07/2024 - Present
 - Support on Tech DD on a variety of topics such as ML, AI, Data, and Software in general. Industries that I know well include E-Commerce, Retail, Media, Automotive, Airline, LegalTech, Banking, and Logistics
- **Beams Safety AI (Acq. by Comply365)** Berlin, GER
VP AI/ML Research & Engineering 08/2024 - 07/2025
 - Responsible for the AI/ML research and engineering team at Beams Safety AI
 - * Implemented a AI/ML strategy and roadmap for the company (covering all aspects from labelling, model development/evaluation and deployment to hiring topics)
 - * Built several ML models (from traditional ML to GenAI) and deployed them to production
 - * Improved security, privacy and DevOps topics
 - Working closely with the product and design team to prototype and implement new features
 - Driving culture changes to make the company ship faster and more user-centric
- **Priceloop GmbH - discontinued** Berlin, GER
CTO & Co-Founder 10/2020 - 03/2024
 - Built up a top-notch product & engineering team from scratch to develop our nocode pricing platform (scaled it to 20 people)
 - Raised money with my co-founder (pre-seed and seed, were funded by Project A and Accel)
 - Code code code and shipping products to our customers
 - Discontinued the company due to the lack of product-market fit and worsened market conditions
- **Axel Springer SE** Berlin, GER
Head of AI at Axel Springer AI 06/2019 - 09/2020

- Establish and lead Axel Springer AI, the artificial intelligence unit of Axel Springer SE, one of the largest digital publishing house in Europe
- My team's research focus was mainly on Voice (TTS & STT) and NLP topics. We also open-sourced several projects:
 - * TransformerTTS (Implementation of a non-autoregressive Transformer based neural network for text to speech.) - <https://github.com/as-ideas/TransformerTTS>
 - * ForwardTacotron (Generating speech in a single forward pass without any attention!) - <https://github.com/as-ideas/ForwardTacotron>
 - * headliner (Easy training and deployment of seq2seq models.) - <https://github.com/as-ideas/headliner/>
- Driving Axel Springer's change into a real "tech" company:
 - * Established and managed the Axel Springer techblog
 - * Co-organized the Axel Springer TechCon 2019 which was the first installment of a group-wide conference within the Axel Springer group
 - * I'm the "face" of the new employer branding for technology within the Axel Springer group
 - * Represented Axel Springer internally and externally at several renowned conferences, podcasts, magazines etc.
 - * Established a more open-source and research-driven mindset
 - * Evangelizer for Tech & Product first

• **idealo internet GmbH**

Berlin, GER

Head of Data Products at idealo

10/2017 - 05/2019

- Co-head of the data team (25+ people) with a special focus on building up the data science/data engineering team (built up from scratch - hired 6 people within 9 months)
- Led the data science team directly where my team's research focus is on:
 - * Interpretability of deep learning models (mainly computer vision problems)
 - * Efficient deployment of machine learning models
 - * AutoML
 - * Data collection process (in-house labeling and external mechanical turk approaches)
- Selected projects of my team:
 - * We used deep learning to automatically rank millions of hotel images (300+ million) according to their aesthetic and technical quality which helped to improve the listing for small and mid-sized hotels
 - * We trained CNNs to automatically generate nice looking product galleries which reduced the workflow time of our content team by 75%
 - * We built a tree-based classifier to predict non-purchases of customers which helped our CRM team to target those customers three days ahead before we receive the actual sales data by the shops
- Provided technical and scientific guidance to senior team members and also our machine learning trainees
- Created the machine learning powered roadmap for idealo for both product and research
- Turned the data team from a pure cost center into a profit center e.g. monetizing our data for CRM campaigns which resulted in EUR 1 million additional revenue in the 1st year and EUR 2 million in the 2nd year
- Set up a regular knowledge sharing session internally and externally across the Axel Springer companies including Bonial, Upday etc.

- Established the open-source strategy under the idealoTech umbrella and executed it e.g. created and managed the idealoTech blog (<https://medium.com/idealo-tech-blog>), idealo's Github landing page and also the @idealoTech channel on twitter
- My team open-sourced several projects with high business impact:
 - * image-quality-assessment (Convolutional Neural Networks to predict the aesthetic and technical quality of images.) - <https://github.com/idealo/image-quality-assessment>
 - * image-super-resolution (Keras implementation of the Residual Dense Network for super scaling images.) - <https://github.com/idealo/image-super-resolution>

• **Pivotal Inc.**

Berlin, GER

Senior Data Scientist at Pivotal Labs

10/2015 - 10/2017

- Leading and managing the Data Science practice for Pivotal Labs Berlin
- Created machine learning models and put them into production for various clients
- Supported pre-sales activities by creating demos/proof of concepts and blog articles
- Scoped data science projects including proposal writing, resource estimations and budget allocation
- Provided data science thought leadership, for example, helped to establish the smart apps idea and XP practices into data science like TDD (<http://tinyurl.com/gme62kr>), pair programming and CI/CD
- Established an API First culture within the company: <http://tinyurl.com/z9kv5ae>
- Gave talks at PyData Berlin, London, San Francisco 2016 and CF Summit Europe 2016
- Data Scientist from 10/2015 - 06/2016

• **Accenture GmbH**

Berlin, GER

Data Scientist at Accenture Digital

08/2014 - 09/2015

- Built up internal capabilities and showcases in the area of network analytics, operations analytics, text analytics, customer analytics and data visualizations
- Worked on setting up an analytics center of excellence for a large German airline
- Led and co-ordinated workshops at customers to demonstrate the value of data science
- Acted as point of contact for internal requests of various advanced analytics topics such as machine learning and optimization
- Supported pre-sales activities by creating proof of concepts for clients in telecommunication, aviation and automotive
- Helped to organize internal and external events such as TEDxRheinMainSalon Datanauts and LMU DataCrunch

• **Others**

Various roles

- I'm a mentor for AI, (tech) products and leadership e.g. Springboard <https://www.springboard.com/>
- I'm part of Google's Developers Experts (GDE) program for Machine Learning. I try to evangelize and build a community around AI and ML
- I was a member of the program committee for Data Festival <https://www.datafestival.de/> for several years
- I've worked for my family's business for years where I managed several things from online marketing (SEO, review portals and social networks) to finance
 - * Sy Restaurant - <https://sy-restaurant.de/>
 - * Hotel Diana Berlin - <https://www.hotel-diana-berlin.com/>
 - * Humydo - Pham & Tran GbR - <https://humydo.com/>

- During my undergraduate I interned at several Investment Banks e.g. Deutsche Bank, Jefferies. I gained experience in M&A, equity research and also asset management
- Thesis Advisor:
 - * Hong Ngoc Truong. Bachelor Thesis, co-supervisor with Prof. Dr. Manfred-Erich Jäger-Ambrozewicz, HTW Berlin - University of Applied Sciences, Germany. Title: "Machine Learning: Tree-Based Algorithms", 2018

Education

- Humboldt University of Berlin** Berlin, GER
 - *Master of Science in Business Administration, Grade 1.9* 10/2011 - 12/2013
 - Field of Specializations: Operations Research and Econometrics
 - Research Interests: Graph Theory, Queuing Theory and Dynamic Programming
 - Master Thesis: Optimal Design for an Online Dutch Auction Selling Airline Tickets
Advisor: Prof. Dr. Kurt Helmes, Department of Operations Research, Grade 1.7
Digital Copy: <http://tinyurl.com/jsq8hwp>
- Berlin School of Economics and Law** Berlin, GER
 - *Bachelor of Arts in Business Administration, Grade 1.5* 04/2008 - 07/2011
 - Field of Specializations: Banking & Finance and Accounting
 - Bachelor Thesis: Best of N Concept - A Comparison of Dynamic Asset Allocation Strategies
Advisor: Prof. Dr. Thomas Wolke, Department of Finance, Grade 1.7
Digital Copy: <http://tinyurl.com/184jskr>
- Study Abroad at the University of Sydney** Sydney, AUS
 - *Exchange Program* 03/2010 - 08/2010
 - Courses taken in Portfolio Management, International Financial Management, International Business Strategy, Calculus I and Linear Algebra I
- Friedrich Anton von Heinitz Gymnasium** Rüdersdorf, GER
 - *Abitur, AP English and Chemistry, Grade 2.5* 07/2007

Selected Online Publications

- **Deep Learning for Classifying Hotel Aesthetics Photos** NVIDIA Developer Blog
<https://tinyurl.com/yadn9wgk> - Jointly with Christopher Lennan 10/2018
- **What is Minimum Viable (Data) Product?** Medium - idealo Tech
<https://tinyurl.com/ybqs55bt> 06/2018
- **My two cents on what makes a good data scientist nowadays?** Medium - Towards DS
<http://tinyurl.com/y9grlbrg> 07/2017
- **8 "Simple" Guidelines For Data Projects** Medium - Built to Adapt
<http://tinyurl.com/m8nhv2o> 04/2017
- **Continuous Integration for Data Science** Pivotal Engineering Journal
<http://tinyurl.com/j6ghfht> 02/2017
- **Delivery in a Land with No Postcodes** Medium - Actionable Data
<http://tinyurl.com/gqat3bo> - Jointly with Megha Agarwal 11/2016
- **How Automakers And The IoT Are Colliding To Save Lives** Pivotal Blog
<http://tinyurl.com/jjcvaxs> 10/2016
- **Test-Driven Development for Data Science** Pivotal Engineering Journal
<http://tinyurl.com/gme62kr> - Jointly with Megha Agarwal 09/2016

- **API First for Data Science**
<http://tinyurl.com/z9kv5ae> - Jointly with Alicia Bozyk

Pivotal Engineering Journal
07/2016

Selected Talks

- **alphalist Podcast Episode #117** - <https://tinyurl.com/2uwd448d> Hamburg, GER
Navigating AI Trends with Dat Tran 01/2025
- **GITEX Global DevSlam 2024** Dubai, UAE
Demystifying LLMs: What's hype and what's real - Joint talk with Tanuj Jain 10/2024
- **Øredev Conference 2022** - <https://tinyurl.com/mwm2xyje> Malmö, SWE
How to Implement a Production Ready Deep Learning Model in 12 Weeks 12/2022
- **Goethe University Frankfurt** Frankfurt, GER
Invited Talk by Prof. Dr. Klaus Miller (Department of Marketing) 10/2021
- **UCL AI Conference 2020** London, UK
Invited Keynote Talk at University College London's Data Science Society 02/2020
- **Future of AI Europe 2019** Berlin, GER
Keynote Talk: The Future of Media is AI 12/2019
- **WeAreDevelopers Congress Vienna 2019** - <https://tinyurl.com/uzy7z8c> Vienna, AUS
Deep Learning for Aesthetics: Training a Machine to See What's Beautiful 11/2019
- **Digitale Leute Summit 2019** Cologne, GER
Fireside Chat about Lean AI 11/2019
- **Infoshare AI & Data Science** Warsaw, POL
Deep Learning for Aesthetics: Training a Machine to See What's Beautiful 11/2019
- **EGG Germany 2019** Stuttgart, GER
Keynote Talk: From ML Research to Production - the Autobahn Way! 11/2019
- **Future of Trust Summit** Frankfurt, GER
Artificial Intelligence - From Science-Fiction to Real Use Cases 11/2019
- **DataHack Summit 2019** Bangalore, INDIA
Deep Learning for Aesthetics: Training a Machine to See What's Beautiful 11/2019
- **AI Show Madrid** Madrid, ESP
Demystifying the Buzz in Machine Learning! (This Time for Real) 10/2019
- **Bertelsmann Data Exchange Week** Bielefeld, GER
Keynote Talk: ML @ Axel Springer 10/2019
- **VSNE Startup Idea Contest - The Grand Final Round** Berlin, GER
Keynote Talk and Panelist 09/2019
- **I.E.C.T. Summer School 2019** - <https://tinyurl.com/sfl58na> Innsbruck, AUS
Keynote Talk and Panelist 08/2019
- **ODSC India 2019** - <https://tinyurl.com/rrtfd07> Bangalore, INDIA
Image ATM - Image Classification for Everyone 08/2019
- **Chief Data Officer Exchange Europe 2019** - <https://tinyurl.com/y3dnk9xl> Berlin, GER
Keynote Talk: Demystifying the Buzz in Machine Learning! (This Time for Real) 06/2019
- **GCAAI 2nd Annual Meeting 2019** - <https://tinyurl.com/y3oqk7y8> Berlin, GER
Axel Springer AI - the past, present and future 06/2019
- **DataHack Radio (Analytics Vidhya)** - <https://tinyurl.com/y4rf5akx> Remote, INDIA
Exploring Computer Vision and Data Engineering with Dat Tran 04/2019

- **hub.berlin 2019 / Big-Data.AI Summit 2019** Berlin, GER
Automate the Boring Stuff with Machine Learning 04/2019
- **code.talks commerce 2019** - <https://tinyurl.com/y4fvkjg8> Berlin, GER
AI Use Cases @ idealo 04/2019
- **Data Festival 2019 / Panel Discussion** Munich, GER
AI impact on P&L 03/2019
- **Data Natives 2018** - <https://tinyurl.com/y8mgvpsv> Berlin, GER
Demystifying the Buzz in Machine Learning! (This Time for Real) 11/2018
- **Axel Springer CTO Workshop 2018** Berlin, GER
AI Use Cases @ idealo 11/2018
- **Süddeutscher Verlag UB Fachinformation** Munich, GER
Keynote Talk: Smart Apps - The New Normal 07/2018
- **Chief Data Officer Exchange Europe 2018** Berlin, GER
Fireside Chat - Creating Profitable Data Opportunities 06/2018
- **Data Festival 2018** - <https://tinyurl.com/y7jrneej> Munich, GER
What is the big in (Big) data? And how lean can your data be... 04/2018
- **Tech Open Air / Panel Discussion** - <http://tinyurl.com/y8vngang> Berlin, GER
New Age of Analytics for Digital Products? 07/2017
- **Pivotal Big Data Roadshow** - <http://tinyurl.com/mnsgcce> Seoul, KOR
Smart data-driven apps 04/2017
- **Cloud Foundry Europe Summit 2016** - <https://youtu.be/z7AmakqpgdQ> Frankfurt, GER
Saving human lives with the IoT 09/2016
- **PyData SF 2016** - <https://youtu.be/HyjZFYDubf8> San Francisco, USA
How you really get your data science models into production - the cool way! 08/2016
- **PyData Berlin 2016** - <https://youtu.be/ZojIGRS3HLY> Berlin, GER
PySpark in Practice - Joint talk with Ronert Obst 05/2016
- **PyData London 2016** - https://youtu.be/SETpipUZ_Lc London, UK
PySpark in Practice - Joint talk with Ronert Obst 05/2016

Selected Open-Source Projects

- **imagededup** - <https://tinyurl.com/yyaoe587> ★ 3000+ ♡ 200+
Finding duplicate images made easy!
- **Object Detector App** - <http://tinyurl.com/yyf7tmu9> ★ 1100+ ♡ 600+
Real-Time Object Recognition App with Tensorflow and OpenCV
- **face2face Demo** - <http://tinyurl.com/y3u6u4cs> ★ 1100+ ♡ 350+
pix2pix demo that learns from facial landmarks and translates this into a face
- **Raccoon Dataset** - <http://tinyurl.com/y29v4uhk> ★ 1000+ ♡ 700+
Trained a Raccoon detector with TensorFlow's Object Detection API
- **jupyter2slides** - <http://tinyurl.com/y4qfenxv> ★ 700+ ♡ 150+
Cloud Native Presentation Slides with Jupyter Notebook + Reveal.js

Skills & Interests

- Computer
 - Very good knowledge in Python including the PyData stack: scikit-learn, pandas, matplotlib, XGBoost etc.

- Working experiences with deep learning frameworks such as Transformer, TensorFlow and PyTorch
 - Very good knowledge in traditional machine learning algorithms to large language models
 - Practical experiences in solving big data problems using Apache Spark (PySpark) and MPP databases
 - Good knowledge in MLOps, DevOps and DataOps
 - Worked under a Test-Driven and CI/CD environment and constantly embraced Pair Programming
 - Experiences with Microservices, PaaS and Cloud Computing (Cloud Foundry, AWS, Azure and GCP)
 - Good knowledge in SQL, Docker, Git, VIM, L^AT_EX, UNIX
 - Experiences with modern frontend frameworks (Next.js, Tailwind) and obviously HTML, CSS and JS
- Industry
 - Industry experiences in Media, Telecommunications (Postpaid, LTE and VoIP), Aviation (Customer Segmentation, Safety), Automotive (Spare parts management, Aquaplaning prediction), Banking, LegalTech, Logistics and E-Commerce
 - Languages
 - German (native), English (fluent), Vietnamese (beginner)
 - Others
 - Taekwondo (Blue belt), Soccer (11 years Landesliga), Traveling, Literature, Cooking, History, Strategy Games
 - McKinsey Masters 2013 Regional Winner and second in the Nationals
 - e-fellows.net Scholarship



Berlin, September 03, 2026